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Grok's AI companions
drove downloads, but its
latest model is the one
making money

Grok's raunchy, [unfiltered AI companions](#) may be making headlines for their [unhinged](#) and often NSFW responses, but it's Grok 4, xAI's latest model, that's been driving the app's revenue of late.

Elon Musk's xAI [launched](#) Grok 4 late on July 9, and by Friday, July 11, Grok's gross revenue on iOS had jumped a whopping 325% to \$419,000, up from \$99,000 the day before the Grok 4 launch, according to app intelligence firm [Appfigures](#).

Grok 4 Drives 4X Growth; Companions Show Impact

Grok · Estimated iOS Downloads Worldwide

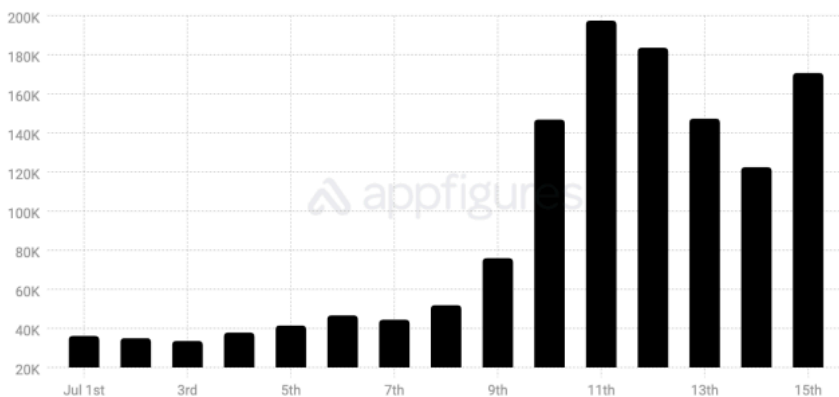


IMAGE CREDITS: APPFIGURES

Grok continued to pull in higher-than-usual revenue in the days following the launch of the new model, with gross revenue over \$367,000 for a couple of days before dipping down to \$310,000 on July 14.

In addition, daily downloads of the Grok iOS app had increased 279% to 197,000 by July 11, up from 52,000 before Grok 4 launched.

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But following the addition of Grok’s AI companions the next week, on July 14, the jump in downloads and revenue was less pronounced. While curiosity about the companions likely drove more installs, the feature isn’t yet poised to be a significant moneymaker for the company, despite being only available to “Super Grok” subscribers paying \$30 per month.

Grok’s iOS downloads globally were up 40% the day after the companions launched, reaching 171,000 daily installs, but revenue increased just 9%, hitting \$337,000.

So while it’s clear that there was an impact from the launch, it’s decidedly smaller than the launch of the new AI model.

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Grok 4 Access Isn't Cheap — But Users Are Paying

Grok · Estimated iOS Net Revenue Worldwide

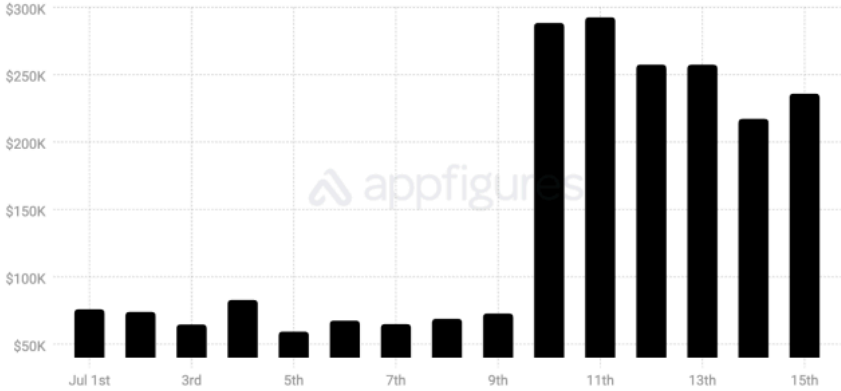


IMAGE CREDITS: APPFIGURES

Given Grok’s expensive new subscription offering, timed alongside the Grok 4 launch, it’s not surprising to see that even a smaller increase in the number of paying subscribers could drive Grok’s iOS revenue significantly higher.

The company [announced](#) that, in addition to Grok 4 and Grok 4 Heavy, it would also offer a \$300-per-month subscription called SuperGrok Heavy, its priciest plan to date. The plan offers subscribers early access to Grok 4 Heavy and other new features, xAI said, but it’s more expensive than comparable plans from other major AI providers, including OpenAI, Google, and Anthropic.

It’s interesting to see this demand for Grok’s subscription plans, even though the AI was initially [consulting Elon Musk’s X posts](#) for answers. xAI has since [addressed](#) this issue.

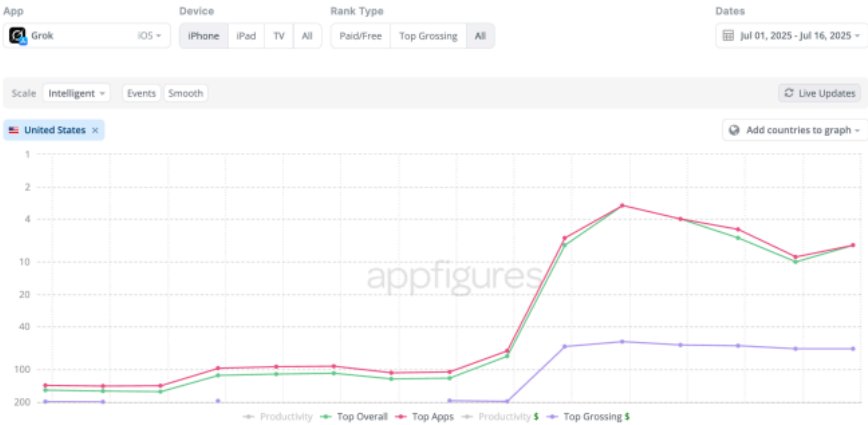


IMAGE CREDITS: APPFIGURES

Interest in the new model also drove up Grok’s ranking on the U.S. App Store shortly after its launch, making Grok the No. 3 app overall and No. 2 in the Productivity category by July 12.

That interest has declined somewhat over the past week — the app is now No. 17 overall — though it’s still No. 2 in Productivity, Appfigures data shows.

Appfigures notes that it focused on iOS data for this analysis, as that dataset is currently more comprehensive than data from Android devices. The latter is only available through July 14 for the time being, as Appfigures’ model needs more time to process Google Play data.

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Sarah Perez

Consumer News Editor |

Sarah has worked as a reporter for TechCrunch since August 2011. She joined the company after having...

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Elon Musk says xAI's chatbot 'Grok' will launch to X Premium+ subscribers next week

Sarah Perez — 9:16 AM PST · November 22, 2023

Shortly after screenshots emerged showing [xAI's chatbot Grok appearing on X's web app](#), X owner Elon Musk [confirmed](#) that Grok would be available to all of the company's Premium+ subscribers sometime "next week." While Musk's pronouncements [about time frames for product deliveries](#) haven't always held up, code developments in X's own app revealed that Grok integration was already underway.

Yeah.

Grok should be available to all X Premium+ subscribers next week.

— Elon Musk (@elonmusk) [November 22, 2023](#)

This week, app researcher [Nima Owji](#) shared screenshots showing how Grok had been added to X's web app, noting that its URL would be twitter.com/i/grok. In one screenshot, users who were not yet Premium+ subscribers would be invited to upgrade to gain access to Grok. Another showed an "Ask Grok" text entry box for

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communicating with the AI chatbot. The features were not public-facing at the time of his discovery, however, but suggested that Grok’s rollout was nearing.

Another image that shows how the Premium+ subscribers will be able to chat with [@Grok!](#)

<https://t.co/iyeOSXwPe0>

<pic.twitter.com/Bcm2oh DrsS>

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— Nima Owji (@nima_owji) [November 20, 2023](#)

First [released](#) on November 4 to select testers, Grok is Musk’s answer to OpenAI’s ChatGPT, Google’s Bard, Anthropic’s Claude and others, and could potentially gain a following as part of X’s broader social platform.

In addition, xAI, the Musk-owned company behind Grok, promises that its chatbot will have more of a personality than rivals. It plans to respond to users’ questions “with a bit of a wit” and is said to have a “rebellious streak,” [according to its website](#). The chatbot also plans to answer “spicy” questions that

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are rejected by other AI systems, the company has noted.

But personality alone won't be key to Grok's differentiation — it will also have access to real-time knowledge via the X platform, which could be an interesting component, if not one that leads to the highest accuracy in terms of its responses.

The addition could help juice sign-ups for X's Premium subscription, which [has yet to fare as well as](#) Musk hoped. The X owner revamped Twitter Blue to become X Premium, promising paid verification among a host of other features, like increased exposure in replies, an edit button, the ability to publish longer posts and videos, and a reduction of ads.

As a result, X recently announced it would split up its Premium service to [include three tiers](#): a \$3 per month Basic subscription which doesn't remove ads, the existing \$8 per month X Premium subscription and a \$16 per month Premium+ subscription which removes all the ads in the For You and Following feeds, and introduces a Creator Hub where users can get paid to post and offer their fans subscriptions.

Grok is joining this higher-priced tier, which could encourage other X users, beyond creators, to sign up. That additional revenue is now more needed than ever as [X is facing an advertiser exodus](#) over concerns about antisemitic content on the platform, and Musk's own behavior in terms of amplifying antisemitic conspiracy theories.

Notably, Grok's expected debut will follow a [week of drama at rival AI company OpenAI](#) where, over a matter of days, its CEO Sam Altman was ousted by way of a board rebellion, then joined by co-founder Greg Brockman, both of whom were announced [as](#)

[new Microsoft hires](#), before negotiations saw [Altman returning as CEO](#) with [a new board in tow](#).

GPTs can save a lot of effort:

pic.twitter.com/VFlrGzPuMN

— Sam Altman (@sama) [November 10, 2023](#)

Though Grok’s arrival won’t have the boardroom drama of OpenAI, Altman has taken notice of Grok’s arrival, even [dunking on the chatbot’s supposed comedic abilities](#), by posting a screenshot of a GPT that instructs it to “be a chatbot that answers questions with cringey boomer humor” and calling it Grok. Musk [responded](#) by calling ChatGPT-4 “GPT-Snore,” adding that “humor is clearly banned at OpenAI, just like the many other subjects it censors.”

GPT-4? More like GPT-Snore!

When it comes to humor, GPT-4 is about as funny as a screendoor on a submarine.

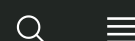
Humor is clearly banned at OpenAI, just like the many other subjects it censors.

That’s why it couldn’t tell a joke if it had a goddamn instruction manual. It’s like

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Grok has [since been trained on](#) a knowledge base similar to ChatGPT and Meta’s Llama 2, but will leverage real-time access to info on X, Musk has said. It will also be able to search the web for up-to-date information on some topics.

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xAI’s Grok chatbot can now ‘see’ the world around it

xAI's Grok chatbot can now answer questions about what's in view of your smartphone's camera, similar to real-time vision features available for Google's Gemini and ChatGPT.

On Tuesday, [xAI announced](#) the launch of Grok Vision, which lets users point their phone at objects like products, signs, and documents and ask questions about them. Grok Vision is accessible from the Grok app for iOS, but not the Grok Android app just yet.

GROK CAN SEE WHAT YOU SEE—LITERALLY

IMAGE CREDITS: [JAAP ARRIENS/NURPHOTO](#)

Grok's voice mode comes with camera access, letting users point their phone at something and ask, "What am I looking at?"

The Vision feature on iOS allows the chatbot to analyze real-world objects, text, and environments through your...

<https://t.co/cmtlNP8yp6>
[pic.twitter.com/N1b6pcYZOi](https://t.co/cmtlNP8yp6)

— Mario Nawfal (@MarioNawfal) [April 20, 2025](#)

Other new capabilities launching for Grok today include multilingual audio and real-time search in Grok's voice mode. Grok users on Android can tap those, but only if they're subscribed to xAI's \$30-per-month SuperGrok plan.

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Aisha Malik - 15 hours ago

Introducing Grok Vision, multilingual audio, and
realtime search in Voice Mode. Available now.

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ग्रोक हिंदी बोलता है pic.twitter.com/lcaSyty2n5

— Ebby Amir (@ebbyamir) [April 22, 2025](#)

Grok has been gaining new features at a steady clip. Earlier this month, xAI added a “memory” component to Grok that lets the bot pull on details from past conversations. Grok also got a [canvas-like tool](#) for creating docs and apps.

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Kyle Wiggers

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Kyle Wiggers was TechCrunch’s AI Editor until June 2025. His writing has appeared in VentureBeat and Digital...

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X plans to more deeply integrate Grok's AI, app researcher finds

Sarah Perez — 11:31 AM PDT · July 5, 2024

Elon Musk's X is exploring more ways to integrate xAI's Grok into the social networking app.

According to a series of recent discoveries, X is developing new features like the ability to ask Grok about X accounts, use Grok by highlighting text in the app and access Grok's chatbot through a pop-up on the side of the screen while continuing to use other parts of X.

The findings were recently shared by independent app researcher [Nima Owji](#). He often tweets his own ideas about features he'd like to see on X. In this case, however, Owji says he discovered the additions on X's website on Friday, July 5, but confirmed to TechCrunch they are not yet rolled out to the public, as far as he can tell.

In one example, Owji found that [Grok could be used](#) via a pop-up on the right of the screen while you're browsing X, similar to how you can check your DMs (direct messages) from the app's home screen via a smaller window overlaid on top of the screen.

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This format resembles how other companies like Google and Microsoft use chatbots within their productivity apps, where access to their AI chatbots is often available in a sidebar to the right of the screen, putting the AI chatbot within easy reach. This placement could allow X users to chat with Grok more often, including when posting to the app or browsing the timeline and coming across new information they wanted to learn more about.

X is working on the Grok drawer which will let you use Grok while using other parts of the app!

pic.twitter.com/eAXxf6lhlg

— Nima Owji (@nima_owji) [July 5, 2024](#)

Other developments show how Grok could become a more deeply integrated part of the X experience.

In one case, Owji found it was being used to research X user profiles, and in another, it was used for searching terms you find within posts on X.

For instance, one new development [would allow users to click a button](#) to learn more about an account on X, though it's not exactly clear what information will be included or excluded in the account summary provided. (Presumably, you could ask Grok today about an account on X to get an idea about how this forthcoming feature may work.)

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X is working to let you ask Grok about an account with a button! pic.twitter.com/UnhOZP6OhP

— Nima Owji (@nima_owji) [July 5, 2024](#)

Perhaps more interesting is the built-in ability to [search Grok](#) simply by highlighting a word found in an X post.

In this case, you could drag your cursor across a term (or terms), and then click on the “Ask Grok” button that appears below the word to kick off a search with the chatbot. This would make it easier to ask Grok about news and information you saw on X, or any other topics where you wanted to dig deeper.

X is working on a feature that will let you select a part of a text in a post and instantly ask Grok about it!

Very cool feature, in my opinion!

pic.twitter.com/g8pHU5sjPf

— Nima Owji (@nima_owji) [July 5, 2024](#)

X last year [added Elon Musk’s Grok to the app](#), formerly known as Twitter, initially as a way to boost paid subscriptions on the Premium Plus plan. With rising competition from OpenAI’s ChatGPT, Google’s Gemini and others, X in March [expanded access to Grok](#) to include mid-tier Premium subscribers, as well.

Despite the broadened availability, app intelligence firm [Appfigures](#) found that X's in-app purchase revenue was still trending down as of May 2024.

According to its data, X saw \$7.6 million in net revenue this May, down from \$8 million in April and \$8.2 million in March. Appfigures theorized this decline could be due to how creators on X are incentivized to post to generate income, which has led many to post often but with little substance in order to increase their views. The firm also noted that the Premium subscription price could be turning off some users. X also has more competitors than ever, with apps like Instagram's Threads, Mastodon and [startups like Bluesky](#) and, [more recently, noplace](#), building text-first social apps of their own.

However, it could be that X is still recovering from its name change, as users continue to seek out an app known as "Twitter." In May, X saw 3 million downloads on the App Store, down from 4.4 million a year ago — a 32% drop, Appfigures noted.

[Why Elon Musk's AI company 'open-sourcing' Grok matters — and why it doesn't](#)

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